



COMPSCI 4ZP6A
slide set 2
(Team communications
SRS
Project Dev Plan)

Capstone project
2026

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Rules about joining a team outside our COMPSCI course

- Note that COMPSCI students can only form groups with COMPSCI students.
- You can NOT join Eng capstones.
- You need the approval of the supervisor to work on the listed projects.



Meetings with instructor (**after groups are formed**)

- I expect to have a review meeting with every group at twice each semester
- There will be a sign-up sheet AFTER teams are formed. Please mark your team number for a 15 minute meeting.
- Please attend on a computer, be prepared to share screen to show progress (more relevant later in the semester).
- If you do not have a good space to take these calls, you can always use the classroom.

Team/Project form (submit individually, all students)

- Use the posted form
- Description
 - The description should make it clear that the project will involve significant software design/development activities. The scope and complexity of the work should be appropriate for a team of 5 to 7 students, each working an average of 10 hours per week.
- **Members of the same team: Please submit identical PDF files with the same file name for project / team form.**
- **For future submission, you will submit per team**
- At a minimum, we will look for the following:
 - **Why** this is worth doing? What is the purpose? Who are the stakeholders?
 - **What** is the expected functionality (high level features, at this stage we don't need formal requirements). Is there a front end and a backend? Is this a web-based system or app or none of the above? Do you have ML?
 - **How** will you go about building it? What are the tools/programming languages/product management systems you expect to use? Do you need data? Do you have the data or a reliable plan to get data?



General requirement for submissions

- In all documents, include:
 - List of contributors and their contributions
 - Version control (what changed in each version) for Git version
 - Glossary of terms
 - Notations if relevant specially in formal design documentation



New as of 2025

- Based on feedback from previous years, we have cut down on documentation requirements. The major change is:
 - **There will be a single document for SRS + Project Plan**
 - **Up to 15 pages**
 - **Submit one per team**
 - **Typical split: Use ~10 pages for SRS and ~5 pages for project plan**

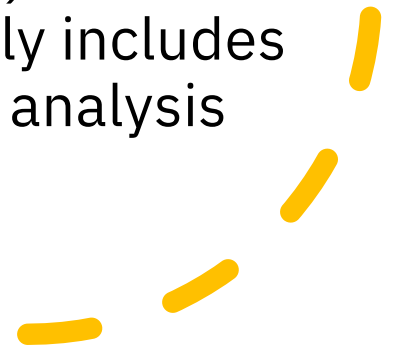
Program management

- Create quarterly milestones (goals) and tasks (manageable chunks of work to cover in a 2 week sprint)
- Use GitHub boards, create milestones and issues (tasks)
- Task priorities for your sprint planning
 - P0 – the system is down and all work stops, until this issue is resolved.
 - P1 – finish this task to unblock someone else, required to be done before other things
 - P2 – ordinary flow of work
 - P3 – nice to have, but not required
 - P4 – informational only



Software requirements specifications (SRS)

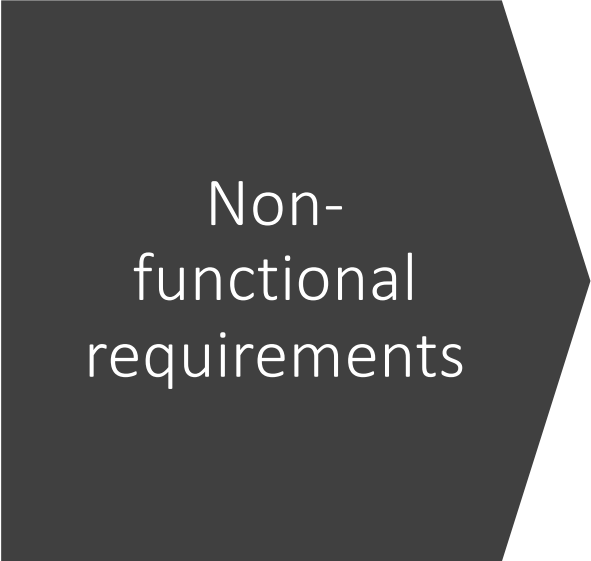
- High level:
 - Mission and purpose
 - The Stakeholders (who it impacts and how)
 - What is expected of the software/product
 - Functional requirements
 - Non-functional requirements / constraints
- If we are proposing a product, Product Requirement Document (PRD) is a more appropriate name. PRD usually includes SRS content, but also market analysis and competitive landscape.



The graphic features a dark blue background with a large, lighter blue circle on the left side. The text 'Volere Requirements Specification Template' is written in white, sans-serif font, positioned to the right of the circle.

Volere Requirements Specification Template

- There is a list 27 sections in the template as listed [here](#).
- Not all headers are relevant in every project
- A few important ones:
 1. The purpose of the project
 2. The stakeholders
 - ...
 9. Functional Requirements
 - Functional requirements are the fundamental or essential subject matter of the product. They describe what the product must do or what processing actions it is to take.



Non- functional requirements

10. Look and Feel Requirements

11. Usability and Humanity Requirements

12. Performance Requirements

13. Operational and Environmental Requirements

14. Maintainability and Support Requirements

15. Security Requirements

16. Cultural Requirements

17. Compliance Requirements

Note on feedback you will receive on your SRS

- As part of your feedback, you might be asked to add features because of low level of complexity.
- Apply these and keep all versions of the SRS on GitHub repo.
- If you do not add these features, your design documents down the road will be deemed insufficient.
- If you disagree with the assessment of complexity your TAs give you, use their office hours or my support session sheet to book time and convince us. Ignoring the feedback is not a good idea.

Project development plan

- **What is Project Development Plan:** Briefly, this is supposed to describe: “Who does what, when, with what tool” and your “what” should cover the requirements from the SRS, along with your workflow and communication.
- 1) Version [Version 0 would be what you submit at assignment deadline]
 - 2) Team Meeting and Communication Plan (including how you share documents and work on them together). Use of program management tools is optional, but strongly encouraged. You can use **Issues** in GitHub for that or use **Jira**, or **Trello**. If you do that, add your TA and instructor. This is a place to gain bonus points on the final submission.
 - 3) Team Member Roles
 - a. Who is responsible for each of the functional and non-functional requirements (multiple people might work on the same component)?
 - b. Who is the coordinator/program manager?

Project development plan cont.

4) Proof of Concept Demonstration Plan

- a. What will you demonstrate during your proof-of-concept demonstration to convince yourself that you will be able to overcome this risk? For example, one approach would be to have a mock website for a service, with limited backend. There must be code. You cannot just plan to show slides. Seek advice from your TA/instructor if you are unsure.

5) Technology

- a. Specific programming language (front end and backend), coding environment. State if will use unit testing framework, why or why not. If your project is primarily software development (as opposed to research), we expect you to follow software engineering best practices including unit testing.
- b. ML libraries (if relevant)
- c. Will you use GPU? Any other relevant technology aspects.

Project development plan cont.

6) Project Scheduling

- a. Include a Gantt chart.

7) Workflow Plan

- a. How will you be using GitLab or GitHub, including branches, pull request, issue management?
- b. Using agile methods is encouraged. You can use scrum and sprint planning in Jira. State if you will do this. We will not monitor your sprints.
- c. Where do you store your data (especially if you are doing machine learning)?
- d. Where do you run compute heavy tasks like training models.
- e. What tool/method is used to achieve each of the requirements and achieve the performance metrics that were proposed in your SRS?